

Data Management Policy Reference Standard

Reference version with stronger controls for governance, quality, lifecycle, and accountability

Field	Value
Document Owner	Chief Data Officer
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Review Cycle	Annual
Classification	Internal Control Reference

1. Purpose

This standard establishes mandatory requirements for governing data across its lifecycle, including collection, classification, use, quality, storage, sharing, retention, archival, and secure destruction. The goal is to ensure data is trustworthy, appropriately protected, and used in a controlled and accountable manner.

This standard supports decision-making, customer trust, regulatory compliance, operational resilience, and defensible data handling practices across all business functions.

2. Scope

This standard applies to all data created, received, processed, stored, shared, analyzed, archived, or destroyed by the organization, regardless of format, medium, sensitivity, or hosting location. This includes data in SaaS platforms, cloud environments, endpoints, backups, analytics tools, and third-party managed systems.

Local procedures must align with this standard and may not weaken the required controls.

3. Data Classification and Ownership

All data domains must have an assigned business owner accountable for classification, access approval, data quality expectations, and lifecycle decisions. Data must be classified according to the corporate data-classification scheme, with minimum categories for public, internal, confidential, and restricted information.

Classification must guide storage, encryption, sharing, retention, and incident-response obligations. Changes in classification must be approved and documented.

4. Data Quality and Integrity

Critical data elements must have documented definitions, quality rules, source systems, and stewardship responsibilities. Data quality metrics should include, where relevant, completeness, accuracy, timeliness, validity, uniqueness, and consistency.

Material data quality issues must be logged, prioritized, assigned an owner, and remediated through a tracked process. Downstream reporting or decisions that rely on known-bad data must include documented caveats and approvals.

5. Access, Sharing, and Use

Access must be based on least privilege and approved by the relevant data owner or delegate. Internal sharing must align to job need, and external sharing must be governed by contractual, legal, privacy, and security review requirements.

Sensitive or regulated data may only be shared through approved channels with appropriate protections such as encryption, access restriction, watermarking, anonymization, or pseudonymization where warranted.

6. Retention, Archival, and Disposal

Retention periods must be documented by record class or data domain and aligned with legal, regulatory, contractual, tax, and business requirements. Data subject to legal hold, investigation, or audit must not be destroyed until the hold is formally released.

When retention periods expire, data must be archived or securely destroyed using approved methods. Disposal actions for sensitive data should be logged where feasible.

- Backups must follow the same retention principles where practicable.
- Shadow copies and extracts used for analytics must be governed and retired on a defined schedule.
- Test data containing personal or confidential information must be masked or formally approved.

7. Security Requirements

Confidential and restricted data must be protected by technical and administrative controls appropriate to risk, including encryption in transit and at rest where required, approved storage locations, identity controls, and logging.

Transfers to third parties, new data integrations, and high-risk processing activities must undergo security and privacy review before implementation.

8. Roles, Stewardship, and Governance

Business owners, data stewards, platform owners, and users have distinct responsibilities. Governance forums must review material data risks, major quality issues, and exceptions on a recurring basis.

Data stewards are responsible for maintaining definitions, resolving cross-functional disputes, and escalating unresolved issues affecting enterprise reporting or compliance.

9. Monitoring, Exceptions, and Review

Compliance with this standard must be monitored through periodic reviews, access checks, retention validation, and control testing where appropriate. Exceptions require documented rationale, risk acceptance, compensating controls, approver, and expiry date.

This standard must be reviewed annually and after significant regulatory, technology, or business changes.

10. Enforcement

Violations of this standard may result in disciplinary action, control remediation, suspension of access, contractual consequences, or legal escalation, depending on severity and impact.